course of my work at DTD&P (Air), ISRO, DRDO and elsewhere, but always ensured for my teams an environment which al owed innovation and risk-taking.

When we first began creating project teams during the SLV-3 project and later in IGMDP, people working in these teams found themselves in the frontline of their organizations' ambitions. Since a great deal of psychological investment had been made in these teams, they became both highly visible and highly vulnerable. They were personal y expected to make a disproportionate contribution to win col ective glory.

I was aware that any failure in the organizational support system would negate the investment in team strategies. The teams would be relegated to the league of average working groups and might fail even there, unable to meet the high expectations set for them. On several occasions, the organization was on the verge of losing its nerve and imposing restraints. The high level of uncertainty and complexity associated with team activity very often proves to be a trap for the unwary.

In the early years of the SLV-3 project, I often had to counter nervousness of the top people because progress